

CIMA Website User Guide

Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators

A Complete Guide for Legal Professionals and ADR Practitioners

Welcome to CIMA

This guide will help you navigate and understand the CIMA website—your gateway to professional development, certification, and dispute resolution services in Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR).

Whether you are a lawyer, law firm, in-house counsel, or ADR practitioner, this guide explains everything you need to know about using the CIMA platform effectively.

What is CIMA?

The **Center for International Mediators and Arbitrators (CIMA)** is a leading organization headquartered in Oxford and Accra, dedicated to:

- **Training and certifying** lawyers and ADR professionals
 - **Providing dispute resolution services** through arbitration and mediation
 - **Building a global network** of qualified neutrals across 33+ countries
 - **Offering professional recognition** through internationally benchmarked credentials
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Understanding the Website Structure

The CIMA website is organized into clear sections to help you quickly find what you need:

1. Homepage

Your starting point to explore CIMA's services, latest news, upcoming events, and quick access to training programs.

Key Features:

- Rotating image showcase highlighting CIMA's global presence
- Direct links to training programs and AI-powered learning tools
- Statistics showing CIMA's reach (500+ professionals trained, 25+ countries)
- Latest news and upcoming events
- Partner organizations trusted by global law firms

2. About CIMA

Learn about the organization, its mission, and leadership structure.

What You'll Find:

- **About CIMA:** Organization overview, mission, and core services
 - **Governance & Leadership:** Meet the president, vice president, and leadership team
 - **Oxfordshire:** Understanding CIMA's connection to the global knowledge ecosystem
 - **Campaigns:** Current initiatives and advocacy efforts
 - **News:** Latest announcements, rule publications, and partnerships
 - **Resources:** Access to research materials, publications, and practice guides
 - **Careers:** Employment opportunities with CIMA
 - **Gallery:** Visual documentation of events, training sessions, and conferences
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Main Services Offered

1. Training & Certification Programs

CIMA offers comprehensive training for ADR professionals at three levels:

Associate Level (ACIMArb)

- **Who It's For:** Early-career professionals, students, and those new to ADR
- **What You Get:** Foundation training in arbitration and mediation principles
- **Requirements:** Bachelor's degree or professional qualification; completion of foundation course
- **Ideal For:** Building your knowledge base in dispute resolution

Member Level (MCIMArb)

- **Who It's For:** Experienced professionals ready to practice as arbitrators/mediators
- **What You Get:** Advanced practitioner training with hands-on simulations
- **Requirements:** 3-5 years professional experience; advanced course completion; professional references
- **Ideal For:** Establishing yourself as a qualified neutral

Fellowship Level (FCIMArb)

- **Who It's For:** Senior practitioners with distinguished careers
- **What You Get:** Recognition as a leading expert in ADR
- **Requirements:** 10+ years experience; demonstrated case experience; significant contributions to the field
- **Ideal For:** Senior lawyers and ADR leaders seeking top-tier recognition

How to Apply: Visit the **Courses** page to see upcoming programs, then click "REGISTER" to complete your application online.

2. Practice Areas Covered

CIMA provides expertise across multiple dispute resolution areas:

- **Commercial Arbitration:** Business disputes, contract disagreements, trade conflicts
- **Construction & Engineering:** Project disputes, payment claims, engineering contracts
- **Investment Disputes:** Investor-state disputes, treaty-based claims
- **Energy & Natural Resources:** Oil and gas, mining, renewable energy disputes

- **Financial Services:** Banking, insurance, securities disputes
- **Technology & Intellectual Property:** Patent disputes, licensing, tech contracts
- **Maritime & Shipping:** Shipping contracts, charter parties, marine insurance
- **International Trade:** Cross-border commercial disputes
- **Sports Disputes:** Athlete contracts, governance issues
- **Labour & Employment:** Workplace disputes, employment contracts
- **Real Estate:** Property disputes, construction contracts
- **Financial Crime:** Fraud investigations, asset recovery

Where to Find: Click **Practice Areas** in the navigation menu to explore each specialty in detail.

3. Membership & Professional Recognition

CIMA offers two main membership tracks:

Individual Membership

For lawyers, mediators, arbitrators, and ADR practitioners seeking:

- Professional credentials (ACIMArb, MCIMArb, FCIMArb)
- Inclusion on CIMA's Roll of Arbitrators and Mediators
- Access to appointments in international cases
- Continuing Professional Development (CPD) opportunities

Institutional Membership

For law firms, corporations, universities, and ADR institutions seeking:

- Organizational accreditation
- Bulk training programs for staff
- Recognition as CIMA-certified institutions
- Partnership opportunities

Benefits Include:

- Global professional recognition
- Listing on publicly accessible Roll
- CPD training and resources
- Networking opportunities at conferences
- Access to CIMA rules and practice guides

Where to Apply: Navigate to **Membership** → **CIMA Qualification Pathway** or **Roll of Mediators & Arbitrators**

4. Dispute Resolution Services

If you have a dispute to resolve, CIMA provides professional arbitration and mediation services.

How to Submit a Dispute

Step 1: Review Your Case

- Ensure you have an arbitration agreement or clause
- Gather contract documents, correspondence, and evidence
- Identify the parties involved and relief sought

Step 2: Complete the Request Form

- Download the Request for Arbitration/Mediation form
- Provide comprehensive details about the dispute
- Specify your preferred neutrals (optional)

Step 3: Submit with Filing Fee

- Filing fees range from \$500 to \$25,000 based on claim amount
- Contact the Registry for specific fee calculations

Step 4: Case Registration

- CIMA's Registry reviews your submission
- You receive a case reference number within 3 business days
- A case manager is assigned to your dispute

Step 5: Tribunal Constitution

- Select arbitrators/mediators from CIMA's Roll
- CIMA assists with tribunal formation
- Proceedings commence according to CIMA Rules

Where to Start: Click **Contact Us** → **Submit a Dispute**

5. Courses & Training

CIMA offers world-class online and in-person training programs.

Current Programs Available:

Maritime Mediation Course

- Duration: August 2026 - December 2026
- Format: Online
- Focus: Resolving maritime disputes through mediation

International Arbitration Training

- Duration: 10-day intensive program
- Format: Live training with simulations
- Audience: Lawyers, in-house counsel, ADR practitioners

Domestic & International Arbitration

- Duration: 9-day comprehensive program

- Format: Mixed online and in-person
- Certification: CIMA credential upon completion

How to Enroll:

1. Visit the **Courses** page
 2. Review course descriptions and dates
 3. Click **REGISTER** on your chosen course
 4. Complete the online registration form
 5. Make payment through the secure portal
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Key Website Features Explained

Navigation Menu

The top menu provides quick access to all major sections:

- **Home:** Return to main page
- **About CIMA:** Learn about the organization
- **Practice Areas:** Explore dispute resolution specialties
- **Membership:** Apply for credentials and Roll inclusion
- **Courses:** Browse and register for training programs
- **Global 100:** View top ADR professionals worldwide
- **Contact Us:** Submit disputes or register as an arbitrator

Special Tools & Links

CIMA Learn Platform

- Access your enrolled courses
- Track certification progress
- Download course materials
- Link: Found on homepage "Explore Training Programs" button

CIMA AI Tool

- AI-powered ADR simulations
- Practice case scenarios
- Interactive learning experience
- Link: Homepage "Try CIMA AI" button

Apply Now Button

- Quick access to course registration
 - Located in top-right corner
 - Direct link to application portal
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Important Pages for Different Users

For Law Firms & Organizations

1. **Start Here:** About CIMA → Governance & Leadership
2. **Explore:** Membership → Institutional Recognition
3. **Training:** Courses → Bulk registration options
4. **Disputes:** Contact Us → Submit a Dispute

For Individual Lawyers

1. **Start Here:** Membership → CIMA Qualification Pathway
2. **Training:** Courses → Select appropriate level
3. **Recognition:** Membership → Roll of Mediators & Arbitrators
4. **Resources:** About CIMA → Resources

For Clients with Disputes

1. **Start Here:** Contact Us → Submit a Dispute
2. **Learn More:** Practice Areas → Select your dispute type
3. **Find Neutrals:** Membership → Roll of Mediators & Arbitrators
4. **Rules:** Resources → CIMA Arbitration Rules

For Students & Early-Career Professionals

1. **Start Here:** Courses → Foundation programs
2. **Young Professionals:** Membership → CIMA Young Forum
3. **Certification:** Membership → Associate Level (ACIMArb)
4. **Events:** News & Events → Upcoming conferences

Registration & Application Processes

To Register for Courses:

1. Navigate to **Courses** page
2. Review available programs and dates
3. Click **REGISTER** button on your selected course
4. Complete the online form with:
 - Full name and contact information
 - Professional background
 - Organization details (if applicable)
 - Payment information
5. Submit and receive confirmation email

Payment Options:

- Individual registration: Pay directly through online portal
- Team/Organization registration: Contact info@thecima.org for special arrangements

To Apply for Membership:

1. Navigate to **Membership** → **CIMA Qualification Pathway**
2. Choose your membership level:
 - Associate (ACIMArb)
 - Member (MCIMArb)
 - Fellow (FCIMArb)
3. Review requirements for your chosen level
4. Download application form
5. Prepare supporting documents:
 - Professional CV
 - Academic certificates
 - Training certifications
 - Professional references (2-3)
 - Recent photograph
6. Submit application with fee:
 - Associate: \$200
 - Member: \$400
 - Fellow: \$600
7. Wait 4-6 weeks for review
8. Receive membership certificate and designation

To Register as an Arbitrator/Mediator:

1. Navigate to **Contact Us** → **Register as an Arbitrator**
 2. Click **CLICK HERE TO REGISTER NOW** button
 3. Complete the online registration form
 4. Upload required documents
 5. Submit and await confirmation
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Membership Renewals

All CIMA members must renew annually to maintain their standing.

Renewal Requirements:

Associate Members:

- Annual fee: Varies by region
- CPD requirement: 10 hours per year

Members:

- Annual fee: Varies by region
- CPD requirement: 15 hours per year

Fellows:

- Annual fee: Varies by region
- CPD requirement: 20 hours per year

How to Renew:

1. Navigate to **Membership** → **Membership Renewals**
2. Review renewal deadlines and requirements
3. Submit CPD record
4. Pay renewal fee online
5. Receive renewed certificate

Important: Failure to renew results in lapsed membership and removal from the Roll.

Understanding CIMA Rules & Procedures

CIMA operates under comprehensive arbitration and mediation rules published in 2025.

Key Features of CIMA Rules:

- Blend of international best practice and local pragmatism
- Globally enforceable under New York Convention
- Efficient case management procedures
- Flexible tribunal constitution options
- Modern provisions for technology and virtual hearings

Where to Find: Navigate to **About CIMA** → **Resources** to download complete rules.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long does certification take? A: Foundation courses range from 5-10 days. Advanced programs can take 2-4 weeks. Full certification (Associate to Fellow) can take 3-10 years depending on your experience.

Q: Are CIMA credentials recognized internationally? A: Yes. CIMA credentials are recognized across 33+ countries and meet international standards.

Q: Can my law firm become a CIMA institutional member? A: Yes. Contact membership@thecima.org for institutional membership applications.

Q: How much does it cost to submit a dispute? A: Filing fees range from \$500 to \$25,000 based on claim amount. Arbitrator fees are separate and calculated per case.

Q: Can I take courses online? A: Yes. CIMA offers both online and in-person training programs.

Q: How do I find an arbitrator for my case? A: Visit **Membership** → **Roll of Mediators & Arbitrators** to browse qualified neutrals by practice area.

Q: What if my membership lapses? A: You can apply for reinstatement, but may need to complete additional CPD hours and pay reinstatement fees.

Contact Information

General Inquiries

- Email: info@thecima.org
- Phone: Contact via email or website

Dispute Submissions

- Email: registry@thecima.org
- Phone: +44 (0) 1865 520 520

Membership Questions

- Email: membership@thecima.org
- Phone: +44 (0) 1865 520 520

Course Registration

- Phone: +233 (0) 50 769 5748
- Phone: +233 (0) 24 673 9535
- Email: info@thecima.org

Office Locations

Ghana Office: CIMA House 4 Naa Shika Avenue Haatso-Mabey, Accra, Ghana

UK Office: Oxford, United Kingdom

Business Hours: Monday - Friday 9:00 AM - 5:00 PM GMT

Tips for Using the Website Effectively

1. **Bookmark Important Pages:** Save frequently used pages like Courses and Membership for quick access
 2. **Check News Regularly:** Stay updated on new programs, rule changes, and events
 3. **Subscribe to Updates:** Use the email subscription form at the bottom of pages
 4. **Mobile Access:** The website works on phones and tablets for on-the-go access
 5. **Download Resources:** Save rules, forms, and guides to your device for offline reference
 6. **Contact Early:** For disputes or membership questions, reach out early to allow time for processing
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Getting Started Checklist

New to CIMA?

- ☐ Read "About CIMA" page
- ☐ Explore Practice Areas relevant to you
- ☐ Review Membership levels
- ☐ Subscribe to newsletter for updates

Ready to Train?

- ☐ Browse Courses page

- ☐ Select appropriate level (Foundation/Advanced)
- ☐ Check course dates and fees
- ☐ Complete registration form
- ☐ Make payment

Seeking Membership?

- ☐ Determine your qualification level
- ☐ Review requirements
- ☐ Gather supporting documents
- ☐ Complete application form
- ☐ Submit with application fee

Need Dispute Resolution?

- ☐ Gather contract documents
- ☐ Download Request form
- ☐ Calculate filing fee
- ☐ Complete submission
- ☐ Contact Registry for guidance

Final Notes

The CIMA website is designed to be your comprehensive resource for:

- Professional development in ADR
- International certification and recognition
- Access to dispute resolution services
- Networking with global ADR professionals

Remember: If you have any questions or need assistance navigating the website, the CIMA team is available via email and phone during business hours.

For urgent dispute matters: Contact registry@thecima.org directly.

For training inquiries: Visit cimalearn.thecima.org or call the Ghana office.

Document Information

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This guide is provided for informational purposes only. For official policies, rules, and procedures, always refer to the official CIMA website and published documents.